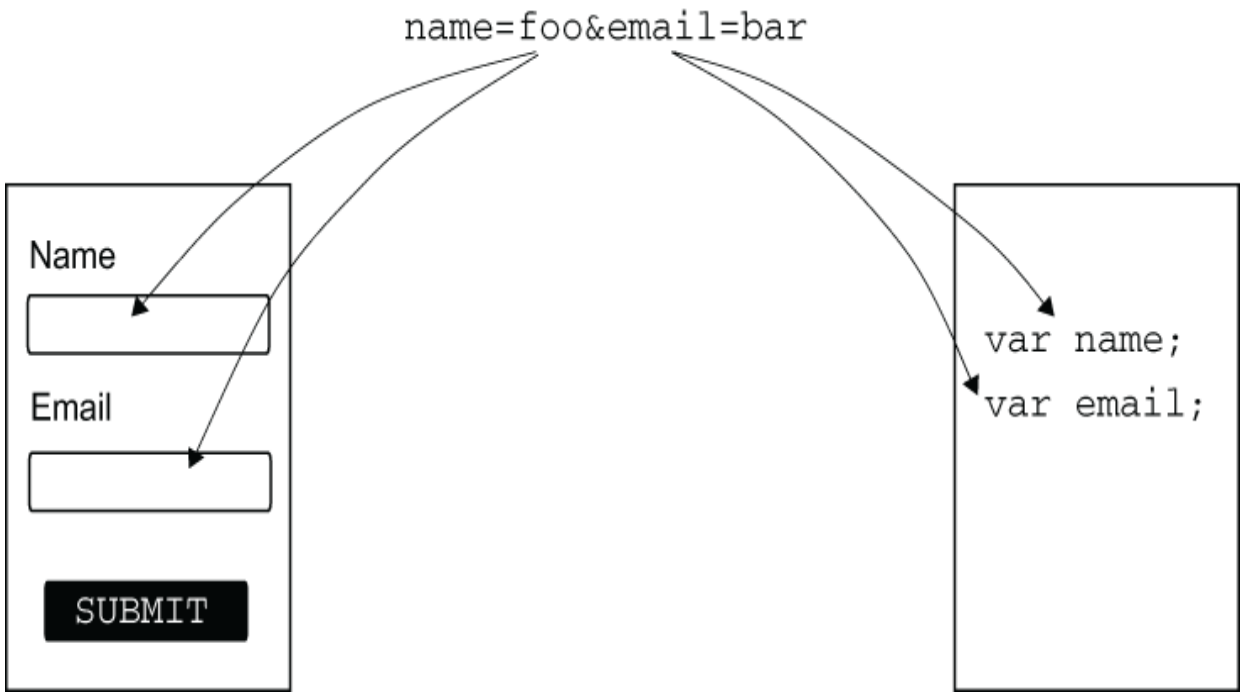


Figure 5.1 Form values are transferred to the server as key-value pairs.

Although it is the default, the GET method is not generally used with forms. You would only normally use the GET method for forms designed to capture query criteria, such as search engines, where the ability to bookmark the URL with the query criteria embedded in the query string enables you to effectively execute the form submission again. Most of the time, you will use the POST method, especially for form submissions that change the state of the application—for example, those that execute operations, resulting in adding new content or updating existing content. The POST method also provides some benefits. It adds a level of security in that the submitted data is not visible in the query string. You wouldn't want your username and password to be visible in the browser address bar for anyone to see, for example.

5.1.1 Using the post-redirect-get pattern